W–P–455a
September 9, 1964
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. W-P-00455 (GSA-FSS)
May 14, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PLATE, WALL ELECTRICAL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers wall plates for use with toggle switches, receptacle connectors, and associated wiring devices designed for mounting in recessed wall boxes by means of integral or non-integral mounting straps.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types.* Wall plates furnished under this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1).

Type I—Toggle switch.
Type II—Outlet.
Type III—Switch and outlet.
Type IV—Combination (for interchangeable devices).
Type V—Blank.
Type VI—Miscellaneous (specify).

1.2.2 *Material and finish.* Wall plates furnished under this specification shall be of the following materials and finishes, as specified (see 6.1).

Material:

Plastic.
Brass.
Aluminum.
Stainless steel.
Painted steel.
Zinc- or cadmium-plated steel.

Finish (metal plates except painted steel):

Natural.
Satin.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566—Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated, Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640—Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall.
PPP-B-665—Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription

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basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547—Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Fire and casualty hazards.

3.1.1 Each contractor shall submit to the contracting agency proof that the plastic wall plates he proposes to supply under this specification conform to the requirements of the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. The label, or listing with reexamination, of the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., may be accepted as evidence that the wall plates conform to this requirement.

3.1.2 Compliance with the above preliminary requirement in regard to fire and casualty hazards does not absolve the contractor from complete compliance with the requirements of this specification in order to secure acceptance of his material.

3.2 Dimensions.

3.2.1 *Metallic wall-plates.* Metallic wall plates shall be of 0.030 inch or thicker ferrous metal or of 0.040 inch or thicker nonferrous metal.

3.2.2 *Nonmetallic wall plates.* Except for decorative lines, that area of the plate which is considered to complete the enclosure of the flush device box shall have a minimum wall thickness of 0.100 inch. For a single gang plate, the area involved includes a width of 1-3/4 inches and a height of 2-27/32 inches, with both center lines coincident with the center lines of the plate. For multi-gang plates, the width of the area shall be increased by the number of gangs involved.

3.2.2.1 Except as provided in 3.2.2.2, that area of the plate beyond the confines of the box mentioned in 3.2.2 may be less than 0.100 inch but not less than 0.080 inch in thickness, provided suitable reinforcing ribs or edge flanges are located on each side of this area. The thickness of the plate, as measured over the rib or flange, shall be not less than 0.125 inch.

3.2.2.2 Small recesses (each not exceeding 1/4 inch in area) having a wall thickness of not less than 0.080 inch may be provided for screw heads without the provision of the ribs specified in 3.2.2.1.

3.3 Color. The color of wall plates shall be as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.1). Painted steel wall plates shall be given a corrosion-resistant undercoat and at least one finish coat of the color specified after surface treatment of basic steel strip.

3.4 Number of gangs. Wall plates shall accommodate the number of gangs and wiring devices specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.1).

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3.5 Material.

3.5.1 Nonmetallic wall plates shall be fabricated of phenolic or urea composition or other suitable material which shall not support combustion for more than one minute after five 15-second applications of a standard test flame, the period between successive application of the flame being fifteen seconds (see 4.4). In addition, the material shall not be acceptable if complete destruction of the sample occurs during the applications of the test flame or within one minute after the application of the final test flame.

3.5.2 Metallic wall plates shall be fabricated of brass, aluminum, corrosion-resisting steel, painted steel, or plated steel, as specified (see 1.2.2 and 6.1).

3.6 Mounting screws. Wall plates shall be furnished with the required quantity of No. 6-32 screws finished to match the wall plates. Screw holes shall be in the median axis of the plate.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level II.

4.2.2 Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2.

4.3 Inspection. Samples of the wall plates taken in accordance with 4.2 shall be visually inspected for dimensional requirements, finish, quality of materials, and defects such as warp, ragged edges, and burrs on metallic plates. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 6.5 percent defective.

4.4 Tests. Nonmetallic wall plates, sampled as specified in 4.2.2, shall be subjected to the flame test described in 4.4.1 to determine compliance with 3.5. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.4.1 *Flame test.*

4.4.1.1 *Apparatus.* The apparatus for this test shall consist of a Tirrill burner with an attached pilot, mounted on a 20-degree-angle block, the burner having a nominal bore of 3/8 inch and a length of approximately four inches above the primary air inlets. The height of the flame, with the burner vertical, is to be adjusted to five inches with an inner cone 1-1/2 inches high.

4.4.1.2 *Procedure.* The sample to be tested shall be so mounted that it will present a flat vertical surface to the flame, and the axis of the burner shall be perpendicular to a horizontal line across the face of the sample. The top of the burner shall be located 1-1/2 inches away from the center of the front surface of the sample, as measured along the axis of the burner. The sample shall be subjected to five 15-second applications of the flame, the period between each two applications being fifteen seconds.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement the definitions and applications of levels of preservation, packaging, and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Preservation and packaging. The preservation and packaging shall be A, B, or C, as specified, (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The wall plates, with accompaning screws, shall be individually pack-

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aged in envelopes. The packaged plates shall then be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Each wall plate, with accompanying screws, shall be placed in a snug-fitting paper or plastic envelope or bag. The containers shall be secured to prevent accidental opening. Twenty-five plates, of one stock number, shall be packaged in a paperboard box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Each box shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Wall plates shall be packaged in accordance with manufacturer's standard practice.

5.2 Packing. The packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified, (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* The wall plates, with accompanying screws, shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-640 (class 2), PPP-B-636 (class 2), PPP-B-621 (class 2), PPP-B-601 (overseas type), or PPP-B-591 (overseas type). The boxes shall be lined with waterproof case liners conforming to MIL-L-10547, sealed in conformance to the appendix thereto. Case liners shall not be provided for boxes conforming to PPP-B-636 and PPP-B-640 when such boxes are waterproof sealed with tape in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. Contents shall be cushioned, blocked, and braced to prevent movement within the boxes. The gross weight shall not exceed the limitations of the applicable specification for fiberboard boxes and approximately 200 pounds for wood-cleated or wood boxes. Strapping shall be flat steel, type I, class B.

5.2.2 *Level B.* The wall plates, with accompanying screws, shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, type I, class 2, style RSC. Bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be not less than 275 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. Gross weight of the shipping container shall not exceed approximately 65 pounds.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The wall plates shall be packed for shipment in a manner which will insure arrival at destination in satisfactory condition and which will be acceptable to the carriers at lowest rates.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, symbol, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type of wall plate desired (1.2.1).
(*c*) Material and finish (1.2.2).
(*d*) Color (3.3).
(*e*) Number of gangs and wiring devices accommodated (3.4).
(*f*) Inspection responsibility, if other than specified (4.1).
(*g*) Level of packaging and packing required (5.1 and 5.2).
(*h*) Special marking, if required (5.3).

6.2 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Plastic

Rail:

Plates, switch or outlet, plastic.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

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Motor:

Plates, switch or outlet, plastic.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Brass

Rail:

Plates, switch or outlet, brass.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Plates, switch or outlet, metal, other than steel.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Aluminum

Rail:

Plates, switch or outlet, aluminum.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Plates, switch or outlet, metal, other than steel.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Steel

Rail:

Plates, switch or outlet, steel.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Plates, switch or outlet, steel.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Military Coordinating Activity: Docks

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—MO(ERDL)

Navy—Docks

Air Force—ROM

Review Interests:

Navy—Docks

Air Force—88

User Interest:

Army—MO

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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